

NOAH SCHOUELA

Email: nschouela@gmail.com. Website: noahschouela.com. London, United Kingdom.

EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

Ph.D., Political Science 2025

Fields: Comparative Politics and Quantitative Methods

Dissertation: “Essays on Fragmented Urban Government and Democracy in Latin America”

Committee: Michael Albertus, Benjamin Lessing, and Susan Stokes

M.A., Political Science 2022

M.A., Committee on International Relations 2018

Thesis: “Localized Criminal Orders in the Mexican Drug War”

Advisors: Paul Staniland and Benjamin Lessing

University of Toronto, Toronto, ON

B.A. (Honours) 2016

Specialist: Peace, Conflict, and Justice Studies; *Major:* Economics; *Minor:* Political Science

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Uribe, Andres D., Benjamin Lessing, Noah Schouela, and Elayne Stecher. 2025. “Criminal Governance in Latin America: Prevalence and Correlates,” *Perspectives on Politics*.

Uribe, Andres D., and Noah Schouela. 2025. “Opportunistic Rebel Strategy in Civil War,” *Political Science Research and Methods*.

Albertus, Michael, and Noah Schouela. 2025. “When Redistribution Backfires Politically: Theory and Evidence from Land Reform in Portugal,” *Journal of Politics*, 87 (2). Sage Best Paper Award - Honourable Mention, Comparative Politics Section, American Political Science Association, 2022.

Albertus, Michael, and Noah Schouela. 2024. “Fascist Legacies of Mobilization and Co-Optation: Evidence from Democratic Portugal,” *Comparative Political Studies*.

WORKING PAPERS PAPERS

Schouela, Noah. “Fragmented Latin American Urban Democracy (FLAUD): Measuring and Theorizing Regionalism in Latin America’s Metropolises,” Available at SSRN.

Schouela, Noah. “Class-Based Voting and Local Election Competition in Fragmented Latin American Cities,” Available at SSRN.

Schouela, Noah. “Nested Urban Democracy: Balancing Partisan and Candidate Information in Lima, Peru,” Available at SSRN.

Schouela, Noah. “Parochial Infrastructure Provision in Fragmented Latin American Cities,” prepared for The Politics of Urban Infrastructure panel at the Bloomberg Center for Cities Research Conference at Harvard University on November 13, 2025.

PRESENTATIONS AND CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

Bloomberg Center for Cities Urban Research Conference, Harvard University	2025
Toronto-Montreal Political Behaviour Workshop	2024
American Political Science Association Conference	2019-2024
<i>Red para el Estudio de la Economía Política de América Latina</i> , Georgetown University	2024
Midwestern Political Science Association Conference	2018, 2019, 2021, 2024
American Political Science Association Virtual Research Meeting	2024
Midwest Workshop in Empirical Political Science, Penn State	2024
Urban Politics in the Global South Workshop, University of California, Los Angeles	2023
Comparative Politics Workshop, University of Chicago	2020, 2021, 2023
<i>Red para el Estudio de la Economía Política de América Latina</i> , Quito, Ecuador	2023
<i>Grupo de Análisis para el Desarrollo</i> (GRADE), Lima, Peru	2023
Midwest Peace and Conflict Conference, University of Michigan	2020
Criminal Governance in the Americas, University of Chicago	2019
Committee on International Relations Workshop, University of Chicago	2018
Program on International Politics, Economics, and Security, University of Chicago	2017

SCHOLARSHIPS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Ph.D.

Bienen Summer Research Award, Political Science, University of Chicago	2020, 2023
Research Grant, Pearson Institute for the Study and Resolution of Global Conflicts	2022
Urban Doctoral Fellow Grant, Mansueto Institute for Urban Innovation	2021
Mellon Research Travel Fellowship, Center for Latin American Studies	2020
Graduate Field Research Grant, Center for International Social Science Research	2020
Research Grant, Pearson Institute for the Study and Resolution of Global Conflicts	2019

M.A.

Marvin Zonis Second-Year Specialization Fellowship, Committee on International Relations	2017
Merit Scholarship, Committee on International Relations	2016

FIELD WORK

Peru, Chile, Argentina, Mexico February-August 2023

Collected data on spatial inequality and segregation, decentralisation, local elections, and municipal governance in Lima, Santiago, Buenos Aires, and Mexico City from national archives, think tanks, government ministries, statistical institutes, and libraries.

Conducted over 40 English and Spanish interviews with academic, political, and government experts on urban governance to gain a context-specific and multi-disciplinary understanding of social and economic development challenges.

Peru January-February 2022

Collected contemporary and archival data on urban land use, informal settlements, and policy approaches toward the urban poor in Lima during authoritarian regimes and democratic spells.

Portugal July 2019

Led a research team in Lisbon, Coimbra, and Montemor-O-Novo to collect archival data on Portugal's land reform and military conscription during the country's transition to democracy in 1974.

Portugal February 2016

Conducted interviews with government officials, business leaders (e.g., oil, banking, pharmaceutical), and academics in Lisbon to study global Lusophone regionalism and international political economy.

ADDITIONAL RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Research Manager (UChicago) 2019-2024

Supervised two research assistants generating case studies on urban governance for select cities, identifying and cleaning fiscal data from municipal governments, and documenting local electoral dynamics. Trained four research assistants to use optical character recognition on quantitative data collected from archives and implement quality control procedures to validate data reliability and digitisation.

Visiting Researcher, Grupo de Análisis para el Desarrollo (GRADE, Peru) 2022, 2023

Collaborated with Peruvian economists and public policy experts to process and analyse data on municipal election competitiveness, electoral campaign dynamics, metropolitan policy prioritisation, municipal spending efficiency, and infrastructural investment effectiveness in Lima.

Urban Doctoral Fellow, Mansueto Institute for Urban Innovation (UChicago) 2020-2021

Presented research to and provided constructive feedback for a working group of scholars in economics, sociology, and the humanities interested in a broad range of research topics related to cities.

Head Research Assistant for Professor Benjamin Lessing (UChicago) 2018-2019

Coordinated and managed a research team to collect regional and municipal census and qualitative data on criminal governance across fourteen Latin American countries.

Organised and presented at the Criminal Governance in the Americas conference.

Research Assistant for Professor Paul Staniland (UChicago) Summer 2017

Researched leadership structures of Latin American Marxist insurgencies for “Leftist Insurgency in Democracies,” *Comparative Political Studies* (2020).

Fellow, Montreal Institute for Genocide and Human Rights Studies (MIGS) Summer 2015

Published six op-eds and five interviews conveying human rights issues for a public-facing audience.

Drafted proposal for partnership with the Romeo Dallaire Child Soldier Initiative to study the rehabilitation of child soldiers and the protection of educational facilities from Boko Haram in West Africa.

Researched and analysed Canadian and British countering violent extremism (CVE) strategies.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago

Introduction to Comparative Politics, Michael Albertus and Monika Nalepa Spring 2021

Democratic Erosion, Susan Stokes Fall 2020

Introduction to Comparative Politics, Benjamin Lessing Spring 2020

OPINION AND BLOGS

“When Redistribution Backfires Politically: Theory and Evidence from Land Reform in Portugal,” The Journal of Politics Blog, April 24, 2025.

“How Criminal Territories Impact Victimization in Latin America,” The Mantle, January 29, 2019.

LANGUAGES, TECHNICAL TRAINING, AND SKILLS

Languages: French (proficient reading/oral), Spanish (intermediate reading/oral).

Coding and Programming: R, Stata, QGIS, Geoda. Working knowledge of Python and SQL.

Quantitative Methods: data analysis, econometrics, causal inference, networks, spatial analytics.

University of Toronto: Quantitative and Statistical Methods in Economics, Applied Econometrics I/II.

University of Chicago: Spatial Data Analysis, Mathematical Foundations of Political Inquiry, Linear Models, Field Experiments in Public Policy, Maximum Likelihood Estimation, Causal Inference.

Qualitative Methods: comparative analysis, measurement, case studies, interviews.

Summer Institute in International Survey Methods, Latin American Public Opinion Project (LAPOP), Vanderbilt University (June 17-27, 2024): sampling, modes, indices, weighting, experiments.

Professional Skills: project management, problem-solving, teamwork, effective under pressure.